

In This Month's

EFY

CD

Focus on PCB Design

TOP 5 SOFTWARE

Cadstar



sPlan



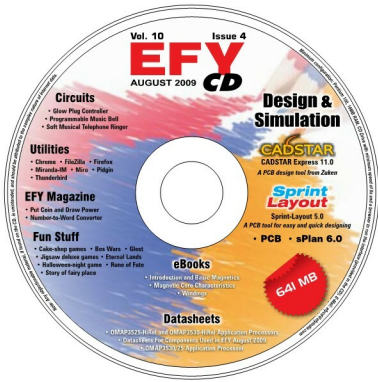
Sprint-Layout 5.0



PCB



Firefox



CADSTAR. CADSTAR Express provides a quick and easy way to experience the features of standard PCBs. It includes all the functionalities of CADSTAR 10.0, limited to 300 pins and 50 components, plus the opportunity to experience Zuken's advanced P.R. Editor XR 2000. For more information, visit www.zuken.com

sPlan. sPlan lets you design circuit diagrams easily and quickly. It is an updated version over the earlier one and compatible with sPaln 5.0 and sPaln 4.0. You can load files from the earlier versions and edit them in the new sPlan. It contains a component library that lets you draw clear and arranged circuit diagrams. You can easily move, rotate, shear or scale all the elements on the schematic with your mouse. For further information, visit www.abacom-online.de/uk/html/splan.html

Sprint-Layout 5.0. Sprint-Layout lets you design PCBs easily and quickly. It offers all the needed functions to design your own layout. It also has an extensive library with all the common components included,

free rotation, automatic ground-plane, photoviewer and autorouter. For more information, visit www.abacom-online.de/uk/html/sprint-layout.html

PCB. PCB is an interactive PCB editor for the X11 window system. It features design rule checking, and can provide industry-standard RS-274-X (Gerber), NC drill and centroid data (X-Y data) output for use in the board fabrication and assembly process. It also offers high-end features such as autorouter and trace optimiser which can reduce the layout time considerably. For more information, visit <http://pcb.sourceforge.net>

Firefox. Firefox made its debut in 2004 and since then it has become one of the most popular browsers. Recently, its latest version, firefox 3.5, was released. This version supports more than 70 languages. Support for HTML 5 video and audio is also available.

Pidgin. Pidgin IM client lets you connect to more than one e-mail account at a time. Connect to AIM, Bonjour, Gadu-Gadu, Google Talk, Groupwise, ICQ, IRC, MSN, MySpaceIM, QQ, SILC, SIMPLE, Sametime, XMPP, Yahoo! and Zephyr.